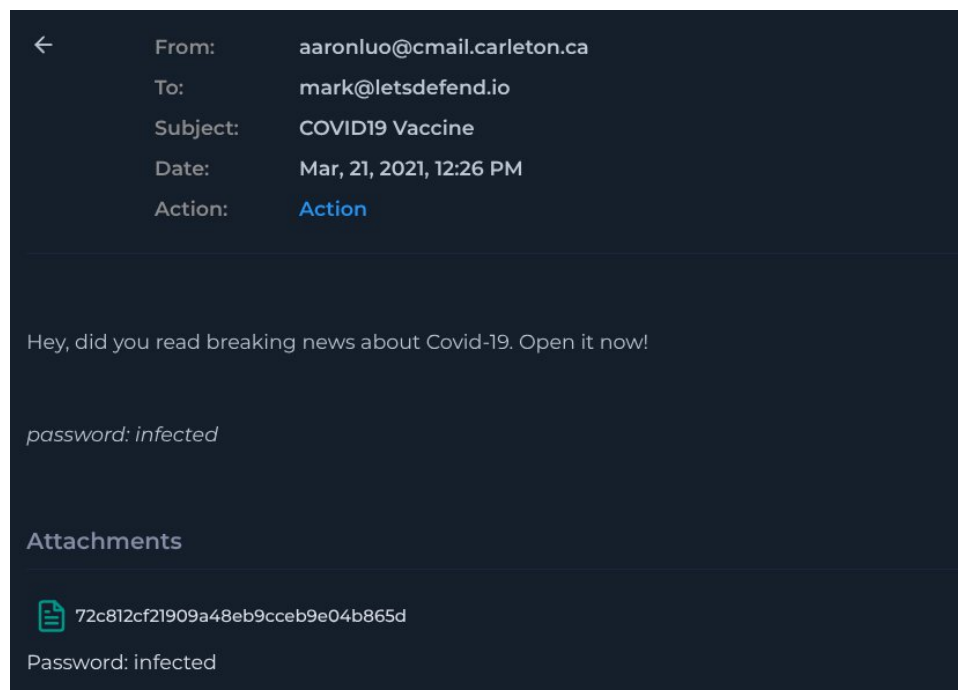


Event Information:

EventID :
82
Event Time :
Mar, 21, 2021, 12:26 PM
Rule :
SOC140 - Phishing Mail Detected - Suspicious Task Scheduler
Level :
Security Analyst
SMTP Address :
189.162.189.159
Source Address :
aaronluo@cmail.carleton.ca
Destination Address :
mark@letsdefend.io
E-mail Subject :
COVID19 Vaccine
Device Action :
Blocked

Analysis Steps:

Logs were searched to find the email which triggered the alert. The email makes use of the common urgency tactic used in phishing campaigns.



The attachment MD5 hash is: 72c812cf21909a48eb9cceb9e04b865d

The file name is Material.pdf

On VirusTotal 31/61 Vendors flag the file as malicious. It is associated with Threat categories trojan, downloader, phishing and Family labels fraud/abdownloader.

31 / 61

Community Score

31/61 security vendors flagged this file as malicious

39f6927c3221134e423769c5d1f58bca4c8bcb87c891c79e390a22b36308eb4

Material.pdf

pdfacroformchecks-user-inputlong-sleepsruntime-modulescalls-wmi detect-debug-environmentdirect-cpu-clock-access checks-network-adapters

Size350.14 KB

Last Analysis Date9 days ago

PDF

DETECTIONDETAILSRELATIONSBEHAVIORCOMMUNITY16+

Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to automate checks.

Code Insights

The document is visually designed to appear as a high-value Purchase Order purportedly from United Caravan Trading and Contracting, utilizing urgent language such as TOP URGENT to pressure the recipient into immediate action. Despite its professional appearance, it exhibits strong indicators of being a Business Email Compromise (BEC) or phishing lure.

A significant red flag is the presence of intentional text obfuscation. The document's extracted text layer consists of garbled characters, whereas the visual layer remains perfectly legible to a human reader. This technique is commonly employed to evade automated email gateways and security OCR scanners. Additionally, the contact domain is a newly discovered domain associated with fraudulent activities and BEC schemes.

Show more

Popular threat labeltrojan.fraud/abdownloader

Threat categoriestrojan, downloader, phishing

Family labelsfraud, abdownloader, hifi

Security vendors' analysis

Do you want to automate checks?

AhnLab-V3	Trojan.PDF.Generic	Allicloud	Trojan(downloader).PDF/Phish.Gen
Allyac	Trojan.PDF.Fraud.AQ	Antiy-AVL	Trojan(Downloader).PDF.Agent
Arcabit	Trojan.PDF.Fraud.AQ	Avast	Other:Malware-gen.[Trj]
AVG	Other:Malware-gen.[Trj]	Avira (no cloud)	Tr/Malware

A report for the file was found on AnyRun where is is also stated as conducting “Malicious Activity” and is also associated with phishing.

Material.pdf - Adobe Acrobat Reader (64-bit)

File Edit View Sign Window Help

Home Tools Material.pdf

1 / 1

100%

PDF

UNITED CARAVAN TRADING AND CONTRACTING

PURCHASE ORDER

ANYRUN

HTTP Requests31Connections22DNS Requests22Network Threats1

TimeShiftHeadersRepPIDProcess nameCNURLContent

BEFOREH1GET200 OK--http://ocsp.digicert.com/MF-EwTzBN...

BEFOREH1GET200 OK--http://oneocsp.microsoft.com/ocsp/...

7458 msH1POST200 OK5316svchost.exehttps://login.live.com/RST2.arf4 Kb1 Kb7 Kb

7462 msH1POST401 Bad Request5316svchost.exehttps://login.live.com/msoapi/device...

Material.pdf

MD5: 72C812CF21909A48EB9CCEB9E048B65D

Start: 22.03.2026, 00:00Total time: 67 s

phishingphish.pdfphish-img

Indicators

ResultsGet sampleRestart

CPU

Processes 12Browser Data 0Actions 1

Filter by PID or nameOnly important

5448Acrobat.exeC:\Users\admin\AppData\Local\Temp\Material.pdfphishing6k8k96

2664Acrobat.exe--type=renderer/prefetch:1"C:\Users\admin\AppData\Local\Temp\Material.pdf"6k3k126

4112AcroCEF.exe--background-color=165140437k3k125

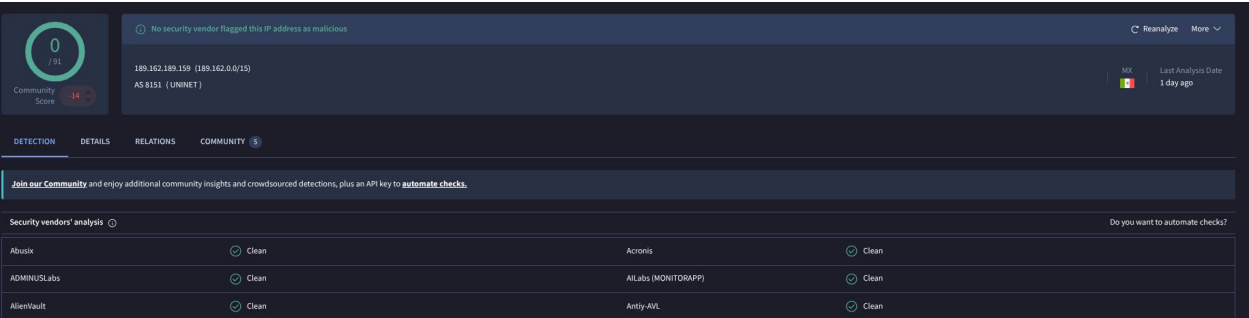
7728AcroCEF.exe--type=gpu-process--log-severity-disable--user-agent-product="ReaderServices/23.120.0"57813488

6200AcroCEF.exe--type=utility-utility-sub-type=storage.mojom.StorageService--lang=en-US--service=...47012074

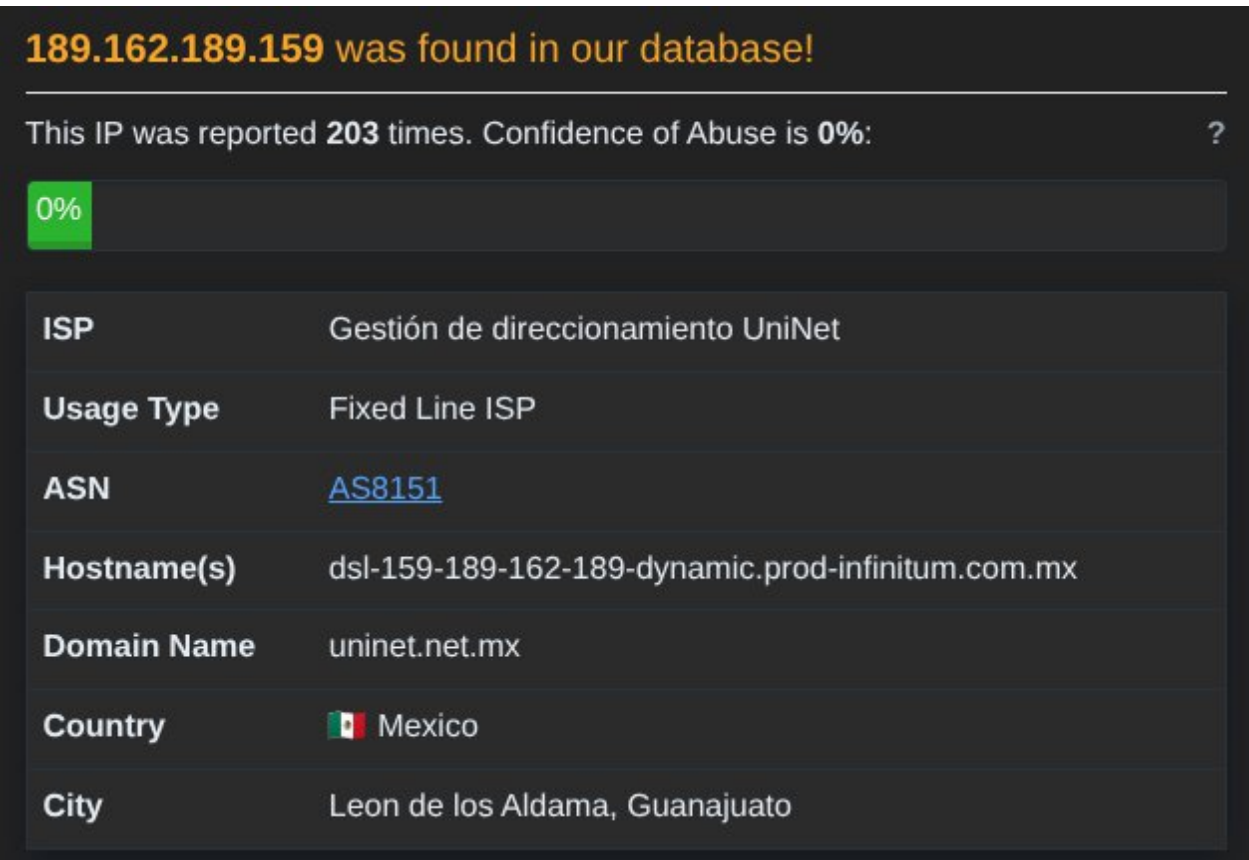
1176AcroCEF.exe--type=utility-utility-sub-type=network.mojom.NetworkService--lang=en-US--service=...66736983

1182AcroCEF.exe--type=renderer--log-severity-disable--user-agent-product="ReaderServices/23.120.0"49712074

The offending SMTP IP is not in our CTI database and is external to the organisation. No emails have been received indicating penetration testing involving the IP for the relevant time period. VirusTotal indicates it is a Mexican address associated with 189[.]162.189.159 AS 8151 (UNINET). 0/91 security vendors flagged this IP address as malicious as of 1 days ago.



On AbuseIPDB this IP was reported 203 times with a 0% confidence of abuse.



Based on following Playbook procedure and the analysis of available information, this alert is determined to be a failed True Positive.

Report:

Incident Summary

Analysis confirms a True Positive, failed, phishing attack targeting an internal user. The threat actor utilised an urgent social engineering lure regarding COVID-19 to deliver a malicious PDF disguised as a purchase order. The email gateway successfully blocked the malicious email before it could reach the user's inbox, neutralising the threat.

Incident Details

- **Alert Name:** SOC140 - Phishing Mail Detected - Suspicious Task Scheduler
- **Target Account:** mark[[@](#)]letsdefend[.]io
- **Sender Address:** aaronluo[[@](#)]cmail[.]carleton[.]ca
- **Sender IP:** 189[.]162.189.159
- **Email Subject:** COVID19 Vaccine
- **Device Action:** Blocked

Analysis and Evidence

- **Social Engineering:** The email body leveraged a false sense of urgency, instructing the user to read "breaking news about Covid-19" and to "Open it now!".
- **Payload Delivery:** The email contained an attachment named Material.pdf (MD5: 72c812cf21909a48eb9cceb9e04b865d).
- **Sandbox Analysis:** Execution within the AnyRun sandbox confirmed the file conducts malicious activity and is explicitly associated with Business Email Compromise (BEC) and phishing schemes.

Threat Intelligence

- **File Analysis:** VirusTotal results show that 31/61 security vendors flag the Material.pdf file as malicious. It is heavily associated with threat categories such as trojan, downloader, and fraud/abdownloader.

Actions Taken

1. Analysed the email logs to extract the sender details, social engineering lures, and the malicious attachment.
2. Conducted OSINT and sandbox analysis on Material.pdf to confirm its malicious nature.
3. Verified that the device action was marked as "Blocked", ensuring the user was never exposed to the payload.
4. Declared the alert as a True Positive and closed the ticket.

Let's Defend Result

SOC140 - Phishing Mail Detected - Suspicious Task Scheduler

True Positive (+5 Point)

Check If Mail Delivered to User? (+5 Point)

Analyze Url/Attachment (+5 Point)

Are there attachments or URLs in the email? (+5 Point)